Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Monday, 26 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Light rain	Rain	Light rain
17° 9°	16° 8°	15° 8°	16° 8°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Prime Minister Andy Burnham says he's open to an 'honest discussion' about Britain rejoining the EU's free movement agreement.**

Mr Burnham wants a 'factual, evidence-based debate' on the issue. This follows years of debate since Brexit about the UK's relationship with Europe.

POLITICS · UK

2 **A British couple were celebrating their anniversary in the Bahamas before tragedy struck, claiming the life of a Nottinghamshire woman.**

Leanne Gregory from Stapleford sadly died trying to save her two sons after they were swept out to sea. Our thoughts are with her family.

TRAGEDY · UK

3 **The government's upcoming budget is set to include a massive one billion pounds for social and affordable housing.**

This significant investment will boost the ten-year housing programme, taking its total funding to over forty billion pounds.

ECONOMY · UK

4 **The King's meticulously planned Caribbean tour is being described as potentially 'the biggest risk of his reign'.**

The nine-day visit will take in three different countries. Royal experts are highlighting the various challenges and potential pitfalls.

ROYALS · UK

5 **Police are investigating after a four-year-old girl tragically died following a fall from a tower block on Saturday morning.**

Paramedics gave first aid at the scene, but the child sadly passed away later. Our thoughts are with her family at this incredibly difficult time.

TRAGEDY · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Sam Fender has reportedly lowered ticket prices for his upcoming tour after speaking out about the cost of live music.**

The Geordie singer has been vocal about making gigs accessible for fans. It's a move that will surely be welcomed by many.

ON AIR — What do you think about gig ticket prices these days? Are they getting too expensive?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Stranger Things star Gaten Matarazzo is making his West End debut and opening up about life after the hit show.**

He's appearing in a revival of the classic musical 'Rent'. It's always exciting to see familiar faces on the London stage.

ON AIR — Who's your favourite Stranger Things character, and what other shows would you love to see them in?

THEATRE · COMING UP

3 **Stephen King's horror classic 'Carrie' is getting a modern-day twist, exploring the horrors of social media.**

The new adaptation promises to bring the terrifying tale to a new generation. It sounds like it could be quite a chilling watch!

ON AIR — Which classic horror story do you think would work best with a modern social media twist?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Xbox is making a big bet on its classic 'Gears of War' franchise in the ongoing battle of gaming giants.**

The new title, 'E-Day', will be an Xbox exclusive. It's a significant move in a competitive market with rising console costs.

ON AIR — Are you an Xbox or a PlayStation person? Or do you prefer gaming on a different platform?

GAMING · COMING UP

5 **Have you noticed more old songs popping up on the charts and your playlists recently? There's a reason why!**

Classic tracks are dominating streaming services and making a comeback. It seems like nostalgia is a powerful force in music right now.

ON AIR — What's an old song you've rediscovered recently that you just can't get enough of?

MUSIC · TRENDS

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Michael Carrick's future as Manchester United manager is under serious threat after a shocking home loss to Bournemouth.**

United were comprehensively beaten 3-0 at Old Trafford on Sunday. The pressure is mounting on Carrick after a string of poor results.

ON AIR — Do you think Michael Carrick can turn things around at Manchester United, or is his time almost up?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England suffered another frustrating one-day international loss to Pakistan, from a seemingly unlosable position.**

An improbable last-wicket stand by Pakistan snatched victory in Lahore. It was a tough pill for England fans to swallow.

ON AIR — What's the most unbelievable sporting comeback you've ever witnessed, or been on the wrong side of?

CRICKET · UK

3 **British gymnast Jake Jarman has made history, winning a second World Championships silver medal in the men's vault final.**

He's the first British male gymnast to achieve two individual medals at a World Championships. What an incredible achievement!

ON AIR — Which British athlete has impressed you most with their achievements this year?

GYMNASTICS · UK

4 **Veteran England bowler James Anderson has expressed sadness after being released by Lancashire, but hasn't confirmed retirement.**

Anderson's legendary playing career could be coming to an end. He is one of the greatest fast bowlers of all time.

ON AIR — If James Anderson does retire, where would you rank him among England's all-time greatest cricketers?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Sheffield Wednesday have sacked head coach Henrik Pedersen after less than fifteen months in charge following consecutive defeats.**

The decision comes after a poor run of form for the club. It's a tough start to the week for Wednesday fans.

ON AIR — Is it fair for football clubs to be so quick to sack managers, or should they be given more time?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **Many Brits are finding unexpected satisfaction in the precise art of folding a fitted sheet.**
What was once a domestic chore is now being reframed as a calming, almost meditative task, with online tutorials gaining surprising popularity.

2 **The delightful scent of 'old books' is topping lists as one of the most comforting aromas.**
It seems a trip to the local library or a second-hand bookshop is not just for reading, but for a nostalgic sniff of history and paper.

3 **A recent study suggests that the sound of a distant steam train whistle evokes a strong sense of romantic adventure.**
For many, it conjures images of classic railway journeys and a simpler, slower pace of life, even if only in their imagination.

4 **There's a growing trend for 'micro-gardening' in surprising urban spaces.**
People are transforming tiny balconies, window sills, and even forgotten corners into thriving miniature green oases with herbs and small vegetables.

5 **The comforting crackle of an open fire is proving to be a top choice for background ambience.**
More individuals are opting for 'fire-side' audio tracks or even videos to create a cosy atmosphere at home, without the actual flames.

6 **Research indicates that watching ducks waddle is a surprisingly effective stress reliever.**
The gentle, rhythmic movement and amusing antics of these waterfowl are being hailed as a simple pleasure for unwinding by the pond.

7 **The satisfying 'thunk' of a perfectly posted letter is bringing joy back to traditional mail.**
In our digital age, the physical act of sending and receiving a handwritten note is gaining a cherished, almost ritualistic appeal.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE DRY TEA BAG A GOOD SNIFF BEFORE BREWING.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of coffee, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: CAREFULLY PEELING OFF THE FOIL SEAL IN ONE PERFECT PIECE.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have that 'one particular piece of furniture' in our home that, for some reason, we're surprisingly attached to.**
  Perhaps it's an old armchair, a quirky lamp, or a well-loved dresser. What's your cherished piece of furniture and what makes it so special to you?

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday scent' just instantly takes you back to a specific memory or a happy time?**
  It could be the smell of freshly baked bread, a certain flower, or even the distinct aroma of a local shop. What everyday scent triggers a wonderful memory for you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called an 'array'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that if you put a raw egg in vinegar for a day or two, its shell will completely dissolve, leaving a bouncy, rubbery egg?

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest commercially produced car was the Peel P50, made in the Isle of Man.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The British Isles are home to over 6,000 different species of fungi.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A single cloud can weigh more than a million pounds.
- The 'kingfisher' can turn its head 180 degrees to look behind it.
- The first known use of the exclamation mark was in a Latin manuscript in the 15th century.
- The popular children's song 'Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star' shares the same melody as 'Baa, Baa, Black Sheep' and 'Alphabet Song'.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES MON 26 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 299 of the year, 66 days left in 2026. Today Accession Day (Jammu and Kashmir, India); Angam Day (Nauru); Armed Forces Day (Benin); Christian feast day: Alfred the Great (Catholic Church, Anglican Church, Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Jon Heder, American actor and producer
- 1973 — Austin Healey, English rugby player and sportscaster
- 1936 — Al Casey, American guitarist (died 2006)
- 1978 — Jimmy Aggrey, English footballer and actor
- 1971 — Anthony Rapp, American actor and singer
- 1980 — Claire Cooper, English actress
- 1954 — James Pickens Jr., American actor
- 1936 — Shelley Morrison, American actress (died 2019)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1977 — Ali Maow Maalin, the last natural case of smallpox, develops a rash in Somalia. The WHO and the CDC consider this date to be the anniversary of the eradication of smallpox, the most spectacular success of vaccination.
- 1944 — World War II: The Battle of Leyte Gulf ends with an overwhelming American victory.
- 1995 — Mossad agents assassinate Palestinian Islamic Jihad leader Fathi Shaqaqi in his hotel in Malta.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: The Battle of Leyte Gulf ends with an overwhelming American victory.
- 1994 — Jordan and Israel sign a peace treaty.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1985 — The Australian government returns ownership of Uluru to the local Pitjantjatjara Aboriginals.
- 1991 — Three months after the end of the Ten-Day War, the last soldier of the Yugoslav People's Army leaves the territory of the Republic of Slovenia.

- 1995 — Mossad agents assassinate Palestinian Islamic Jihad leader Fathi Shaqaqi in his hotel in Malta.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES TUE 27 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 300 of the year, 65 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abbán; Christian feast day: Abraham the Poor; Christian feast day: Gaudiosus of Naples; Christian feast day: Kaleb of Axum. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Jonathan Stroud, English author
- 1972 — Evan Coyne Maloney, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1958 — David Hazeltine, American pianist and composer
- 1958 — Simon Le Bon, English singer-songwriter
- 1968 — Vinny Samways, English footballer and manager
- 1943 — Carmen Argenziano, American actor and producer (died 2019)
- 1963 — Marla Maples, American model and actress
- 1984 — Kelly Osbourne, English television personality

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1979 — Saint Vincent and the Grenadines gains its independence from the United Kingdom.
- 1980 — The Chun Doo-hwan government forcibly arrests and investigates monks and personnel of the Jogye Order.
- 1958 — Iskander Mirza, the first President of Pakistan, is deposed by General Ayub Khan, who had been appointed the enforcer of martial law by Mirza 20 days earlier.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1999 — Gunmen open fire in the Armenian Parliament, killing the Prime Minister and seven others.
- 1993 — Widerøe Flight 744 crashes in Overhalla Municipality, Norway, killing six people.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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